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HAJ PILGRIMS RETURN TO WARM WELCOME IN DUBAI

■ Returning Haj pilgrims arriving through Dubai airports were greeted with a special passport stamp bearing the message, 'The UAE Welcomes the Return of Pilgrims', as part of an initiative launched by Dubai's General Directorate of Identity and Foreigners Affairs (GDRFA). Pilgrims were welcomed by GDRFA staff and a group of children who presented flowers and commemorative gifts.

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UAE residents to see five major changes from today

NEW PARKING, SALIK FEES, SALARY RULES COME INTO FORCE

DUBAI

BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

UAE residents will see a number of important changes come into force today, affecting everything from daily commuting costs and salary payments to the legal rights of young adults. The new measures are expected to have a direct impact on motorists, private sector employees, employers and families across the country.

Higher costs for motorists

Drivers in Dubai will pay more for parking and toll crossings after a 5 per cent Value Added Tax (VAT) is applied to public parking services and Salik charges.

The changes will increase the overall amount motorists pay for parking and using toll gates, while Salik tag activation fees will also become more expensive.

Adding to transport costs, UAE motorists will see fuel prices rise for a fourth consecutive month in June, with petrol prices increasing by about 30 fils per litre. Diesel prices, meanwhile, have dropped by 36 fils.

The most immediate effects will be felt in day-to-day commuting costs, workplace compliance requirements and the expanded legal rights available to young people as they enter adulthood.

End of cash parking payments

Dubai is also taking another step towards a fully digital transport ecosystem.

From June 1, motorists will no longer be able to use cash or coins at parking meters. Parking fees must instead be paid through approved digital channels, including mobile applications, SMS and smart payment systems.

New salary payment requirements

Private sector employers covered by the Wage Protection System will have to comply with revised salary payment timelines.

Under the updated rules, sala-

ries become due from the first day of the month following the wage period. The move is aimed at strengthening employee protections, improving transparency and ensuring workers receive salaries on time.

Legal adulthood lowered to 18

A major legal reform taking effect this month lowers the UAE's age of majority from 21 to 18 under the new Civil Transactions Law. The change gives 18-year-olds full legal capacity to independently sign contracts, manage finances, open bank accounts, establish businesses and undertake legal transactions without requiring guardian approval.

Wider impact on daily life

Taken together, the changes reflect the UAE's ongoing efforts to modernise regulations, strengthen worker and consumer protections, and accelerate digital services. For residents, the most immediate effects will be felt in day-to-day commuting costs, workplace compliance requirements and the expanded legal rights available to young people as they enter adulthood.

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